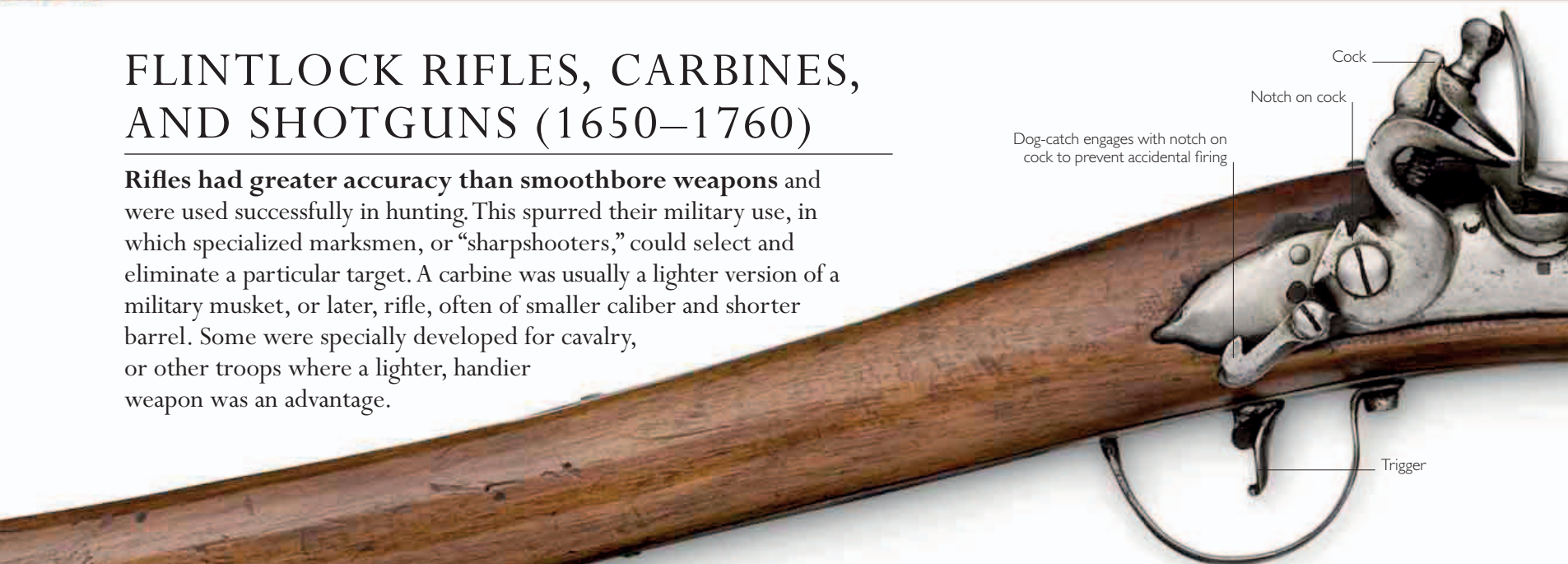


FLINTLOCK RIFLES, CARBINES, AND SHOTGUNS (1650–1760)

Rifles had greater accuracy than smoothbore weapons and were used successfully in hunting. This spurred their military use, in which specialized marksmen, or “sharpshooters,” could select and eliminate a particular target. A carbine was usually a lighter version of a military musket, or later, rifle, often of smaller caliber and shorter barrel. Some were specially developed for cavalry, or other troops where a lighter, handier weapon was an advantage.



▲ FLINTLOCK REVOLVING SPORTING GUN

Date c.1670

Origin France

Barrel 31¼in (79.5cm)

Caliber .59in (15.1mm)

French gunmakers produced some of the finest sporting guns of the 17th century. This rifle has three revolving chambers, each equipped with its own striker and spring. All revolvers, and other multibarrel guns, of the muzzle-loading type were at risk from a dangerous chain reaction, in which firing one chamber could accidentally set off all the others.



▼ PRUSSIAN RIFLED FLINTLOCK CARBINE

Date 1722

Origin Prussia

Barrel 37in (94cm)

Caliber .66in (16.7mm)

This carbine was manufactured until 1774 at the Prussian state arsenal at Potsdam (in modern-day Germany). The name of the armory is engraved on the lock plate.

